INTRODUCTION TO GAMES

Part 12: Recap

1.

IGA1 Content

In a nutshell.

Lecture 1: Game Basics (WH)

How to Define Games?

Rule-based, quantifiable outcome, valorization of outcome, player effort, attached to the outcome

State of the Art in Games

Remakes & remixes, innovation in AAA games

Analyzing Games

Dramatic and formal elements (Tracy Fullerton)

Lecture 2: History of Games (WH)

Humble Beginnings (40s, 50s, 60s)

Chess, Nimrod, Tennis for Two, Spacewar!

Video Games are Born (70s)

Pong, Space Invaders, Asteroids, Adventure, Atari 2600

Rise and Fall (80s)

Pac-Man, MUD, NES, Tetris, Super Mario Bros., Zelda, Game Boy

Technological Advancements and Present (90s, 2000s, 2010s+)

Sonic, Wolfenstein, Doom, PS1, Tomb Raider, CS, GTA, XBOX, WoW, iPhone

Lecture 3 & 4: Game Design & Prototyping (ML)

Game Design Literature

Jesse Schell: The Art of Game Design

Experiences in Games

What are experiences, structure of an experience

Player Types

Bartle, BrainHex

Game Mechanics

Definition and Literature (Adams, Dormans: Game Mechanics), MDA framework, core mechanics, 5 different types of mechanics, discrete vs. continuous mechanics, mechanics and game genres

Lecture 5: Level Design (AM)

Level Design

Level Design vs. Game Design vs. Environment Art

Level Elements

Challenges, Motivation, Skills & Player Experience

Spatial Composition & Building Vocabulary

Types of Levels, Affordances & Readability

How to make a level

From Ideation to Playtesting

Lecture 6: Game Art (AM)

(Game) Art?

Art, Games as Art, Art in Games

Game Art as Space.

Camera Perspective + Dimensionality

Game Art as Environment and Orientation.

The Witness / Mirror's Edge

Game Art as Identification.

Avatar / Character

Lecture 7: Game Interfaces (WH)

What's an interface?

Examples, definition, status, and progress, teaching concepts, and control

How do interfaces work?

Physical input/output, virtual interface, world

Types of interfaces

Diegetic, non-diegetic, spatial, meta

Creating interfaces

Approaches, interface design documentation, sketches, specs, considerations

Lecture 8: Playtesting (WH)

What is Playtesting?

Why playtesting, examples

Playtesting Methods

Questionnaires, focus groups, physiological measurements, and heuristic evaluation

Playtests in Practice

Halo 3, benefits & drawbacks

Gaze & Games

Eye-tracking technology, state of the art, presence, examples

Lecture 9: Game Ideation 1 (ML)

Game Ideas

Examples, think outside of AAA games

Idea to Game

Examples from The Unfinished Swan, Braid and Monument Valley

Idea to Story

4-Layers-Narrative-Design-Approach, core elements of storytelling

Lecture 10: Game Ideation 2 (ML)

Emotion in Games

Literature (Katherine Isbister), defining emotions,

Basic Emotions in Games

Journey (social interaction), Flower (joy), Gris (sadness), Getting Over It with Bennett Foddy (anger), Manifold Garden (surprise), Scorn (disgust)

Social Emotions in Games & Social play

Avatars and projection, multiplayer emotion

Lecture 11: Games Research (ML)

What is games research?

The what, when, and where?

Game studies: games as culture and meaning

How scholars work, ludology & narratology, key areas for game studies

Games & HCI: interaction and player experience

What is HCI, player experience, flow, immersion, emotions

Games user research and UX in the industry

What do games user researchers do, methods

Methods, ethics, and where to learn

Desire paths game example